

Who Cried Wolf?

written by

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INT. ACADEMIC CENTER - DAY

A NARRATOR, A professor enters the room and stands at a lectern in a college classroom.

NARRATOR

Today we look back at one of the most prolific writers of the Roman Empire, Petronius. Very little is known of his early life.

Someone in the crowd coughs loudly. The professor looks annoyed, but continues without breaking a beat.

NARRATOR (CONT'D)

However, by the year 27 AD he had risen to the place of being one of Nero's closest advisors.

A small cough from the classroom and a sniffle. This causes the professor to pause.

NARRATOR (CONT'D)

As I was saying, Petronius was a highly skilled philosopher and one of the great orators of his time.

INT. ANCIENT ROME - DAY

Petronius holds a scroll and waves his hands as he speaks in front of a crowd of Romans. Gesticulating as if giving a fiery speech.

PETRONIUS

And this is why the Gods have clearly shown that the egg, not the chicken, came first!

The crowd claps in appreciation.

PETRONIUS (CONT'D)

Unless you include the rooster, because that's how we get eggs. Get it?

The crowd laughs.

PETRONIUS (CONT'D)

I know, I know. I'm a genius. You're too kind. No really, you're a great crowd! We're talking about chickens! It's groundbreaking stuff!

INT. ACADEMIC CENTER - DAY

NARRATOR (V.O.)
Petronius was also prolific writer
of comedy.

INT. ROMAN HOME - DAY

Petronius is writing at a desk cracking himself up laughing.
He slaps his knee and let's out a very peculiar laugh and
points at the paper, as he speaks to himself.

PETRONIUS
Oh this joke is too good! Diana
come in here and listen to my
latest joke!

Diana enters the room annoyed and holding an ancient scroll.

DIANA
Why do you always have to interrupt
me scrolling?

Petronius ignores her question.

PETRONIUS
Listen. "My jokes are just like
food, poor people just don't get
it".

Petronius bursts into laughter. Diana stays straight-faced.

DIANA
But you're broke?

PETRONIUS
Well, I mean, but the other members
of the court are very well off...

Petronius loses his smile.

PETRONIUS (CONT'D)
You can go back to scrolling now.

INT. ACADEMIC CENTER - DAY

NARRATOR (V.O.)
Further, a lesser known fact, was
Petronius was also a prolific
womanizer.

INT. ROMAN BAR - NIGHT

Petronius holds a goblet of wine as he flirtatiously talks with a few women.

PETRONIUS

Hello ladies... how would you girls
like to head back to my place and
we can play 'Hide the Minotaur?'

He quite clearly offends one of the women and she splashes her drink in his face. Petronius frowns. Then all the woman slap him across the face.

INT. ACADEMIC CENTER - DAY

NARRATOR

Looking through accounts of the
period's historians, we have
concluded that Petronius'
contributions to Nero's Rome were
lauded by his contemporaries.
However, these accolades were
tempered with

Someone starts comedically coughing in the crowd. The professor tries to go on.

NARRATOR (CONT'D)

However, these accolades were...

The coughing starts up again and the exasperated professor pulls a flask from his jacket and comedically pours bourbon into his coffee, shrugs to himself and takes a long drink from the flask.

NARRATOR (CONT'D)

(Whispering) Fucking freshman....
(beat) Are we good now?

STUDENT

Sorry.

NARRATOR

As I was saying, Petronius'
accolades were tempered by his
contemporaries because of his
raucous lifestyle.

The professor looks over his shoulder and then puts his hand to the side of his face to secretly share.

NARRATOR (CONT'D)

For example, Petronius was given the nickname "the Olive tree" due to his tendency to wear offensively short togas that exposed his testicles.

The student's stay silent.

NARRATOR (CONT'D)

Anyway, despite serving in many prominent roles of in Nero's court, it is due to Petronius's greatest comedy, The Satyricon, for which we know him today. Interestingly, this book almost never came to be due to a terrible confrontation between Petronius and the Roman General Brutus Maximus, who believed Petronius had slept with his wife.

INT. NERO'S COURT - DAY

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS is angrily walking through the crowd of Romans in Nero's Court and suddenly stops in front of PETRONIUS.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

Consul Petronius, during my many campaigns for Rome I have learned to never trust a Parthian hand shake, a Persian maid or, apparently, a Consul's Morals!

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS throws clothes in the ground.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS (CONT'D)

Perhaps you would like to explain why I found your monogrammed undergarments outside the window of my wife's bed chamber!

INT. ACADEMIC CENTER - DAY

NARRATOR

This was, of course, was because Petronius was shagging General Maximus' wife. Oh, And not just once.

(MORE)

NARRATOR (CONT'D)
No, according to the histories he
was her regular Tuesday night
visitor because, as I alluded
before, his penis was reportedly
rather large.

INT. ROMAN HOME - NIGHT

PETRONIUS is sitting in the bed with the GENERAL'S WIFE. She
gives the camera a thumbs up and smiles as PETRONIUS smirks
at the camera.

THE GENERAL'S WIFE
It's like an olive tree.

PETRONIUS
That means it's good.

Petronius winks at the camera.

INT. NERO'S COURT - DAY

PETRONIUS
General Maximus! I am appalled that
you would think I would visit your
wife's bed chambers!

General Maximus gives Petronius a quick punch to the gut.

PETRONIUS (CONT'D)
(whimpering)
Owwwie...

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS
Then how do you explain this, liar!

The GENERAL points at the clothes on the ground.

PETRONIUS
Uh... It is an alarming tale.... In
fact, when I tell you the truth of
the matter you'll find it obvious
and totally reasonable.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS
I doubt that!

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS balls up his fist and pulls back to
punch PETRONIUS.

PETRONIUS

WAIT, WAIT, WAIT! I have one key point to make! Sir. General, I would never sleep with your wife. In fact, I would be revolted!

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

And what's wrong with my wife?!

PETRONIUS

Uh, well, nothing! Nothing to be honest. She's actually a very well-built lady and very pleasing to the eye. In fact...

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS growls and pulls back his fist again.

PETRONIUS (CONT'D)

WAIT!... Boys!

Yeah, that the thing, General!

I'm a Roman and I like young boys!

The Romans around them begin nodding as if the answer is obvious.

ROMAN PHILOSOPHER

That seems reasonable.

PETRONIUS

Exactly! Thank you. That's right general, I like young boys! The younger the better.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

What the fu-?!

PETRONIUS

I'm positive, in fact I'd rather sleep with you than your wife. Unless you're not into that, in which case it's my loss.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

Yeah, that's not my thing.

PETRONIUS

(Whispering)

Thank the Gods...

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

What was that?

PETRONIUS

I said, well damn my luck. I mean,
you've got quite an ass on you sir.
Do you do Pilates?

PETRONIUS sighs in relief

PETRONIUS (CONT'D)

Anyway, as you can now clearly
understand General, I wasn't
lurking outside your wife's bedroom
after spending an evening of
ecstasy with her.

INT. ROMAN HOME - MORNING

PETRONIUS

I wish this evening of ecstasy
would never end.

THE GENERAL'S WIFE

Yeah, yeah, go make me a Gyro.

PETRONIUS

Snappy today aren't we!

INT. NERO'S COURT - DAY

The general points at the undergarments.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

Then how do you explain those!

PETRONIUS

I was just getting to that...

Petronius turns around and holds his head.

PETRONIUS (CONT'D)

(Whispering) Shit, shit, shit...
Think!

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

I'm waiting.

Petronius looks around and sees the Capitoline Wolf statue.

PETRONIUS

(Whispering) Oh!
It was a werewolf.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

A what?

PETRONIUS

That's right, I saw a werewolf!

INT. ROMAN HOME - NIGHT

A bedroom with the WEREWOLF and the Generals' wife sitting up in bed. She is looks over at the Werewolf expecting Petronius. She screams and runs away. The werewolf follows her.

INT. NERO'S COURT - DAY

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

What the hell is a Werewolf?

PETRONIUS

A Werewolf is a foul creature,
cursed by the Gods.
It is a hybrid of both Wolf and
Man. And, As good as I could tell,
the deadly beast has only the
carnal ferocity of a wolf and none
of a man's reason.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

Petronius, you expect me to believe
that? You're pulling my...

PETRONIUS

Oh, I'd like to General but you've
already said no and I don't act
without consent.

ROMAN PHILOSOPHER #2

(whisper)

The Biggest lie he's told today.

PETRONIUS

However, back to my point. You
see, I was carrying home my laundry
when I saw the beast near your
estate.

EXT. ROMAN HOME - NIGHT

A werewolf is prowling around a window. Polonius slowly walks into frame looking shocked.

PETRONIUS, VO

It was prowling about outside a window, that I can only assume, was the one that belonged to your wife. In fear for the safety of your household, I threw a stone and struck the beast.

PETRONIUS, holding laundry, throws a rock at the Werewolf. The rock hits the werewolf and it turns angrily and focuses on PETRONIUS.

INT. NERO'S COURT - DAY

PETRONIUS

That was a poorly conceived plan.

EXT. ROMAN HOME - NIGHT

PETRONIUS drops the laundry and runs screaming as the Werewolf chases him.

INT. NERO'S COURT - DAY

PETRONIUS

Luckily I escaped with my life and it was absolutely my intention to speak with you Maximus, but I didn't want to stir fear up among the commoners.

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

Well... I guess that makes sense.

PETRONIUS

Sure it does, General. Besides whom would try to sneak around with a General's wife?

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS

I guess you're right, Consul Petronius.

PETRONIUS

Sure I am. You think a man could just make up some bullshit tale about a mythical beast just to cover for the fact he's been banging a general's smoking hot wife? That's insanity!

GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS
Right! Especially with you being a
boy lover!

PETRONIUS
Damn right, General, you know us
Romans. We love our boys!

The camera begins to pull back and the sound fades as
PETRONIUS continues lying to the GENERAL BRUTUS MAXIMUS and
the other extras around them.

NARRATOR (V.O.)
The story Petronius fabricated
about his harrowing account quickly
spread on the streets of Rome.

INT. ACADEMIC CENTER - DAY

NARRATOR
As his tale's popularity grew,
Petronius decided to include it in
one of his written works, the
Satyricon. As you might expect,
with the fame of Petronius' book,
stories of werewolves have spread
ever since.

STUDENT
But werewolf are just fiction
right?

NARRATOR
Of course. There's no such thing as
werewolves.

The WEREWOLF attacks the professor from stage right.